

Mastek™



GOOD

SIMON^{ON}
THE
STREETS

Frontline Case Management: Research Report

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The Work

- ✓ Mobile
- ✓ Time-pressured
- ✓ Relationship-based
- ✓ Interrupted
- ✓ Practical

The current case management process does not fit the reality of frontline outreach work. It creates an avoidable administrative burden that actively reduces time staff can spend with the people they support.

The System

Rigid



Admin-heavy



Deeply structured



Requires manual data retrofitting



Ground-Up Methodology

To understand the system, we didn't look at process maps—we looked at practice. Participants mapped real, recent interactions across three simple variables to identify exactly where the current system creates friction.



Worker Actions

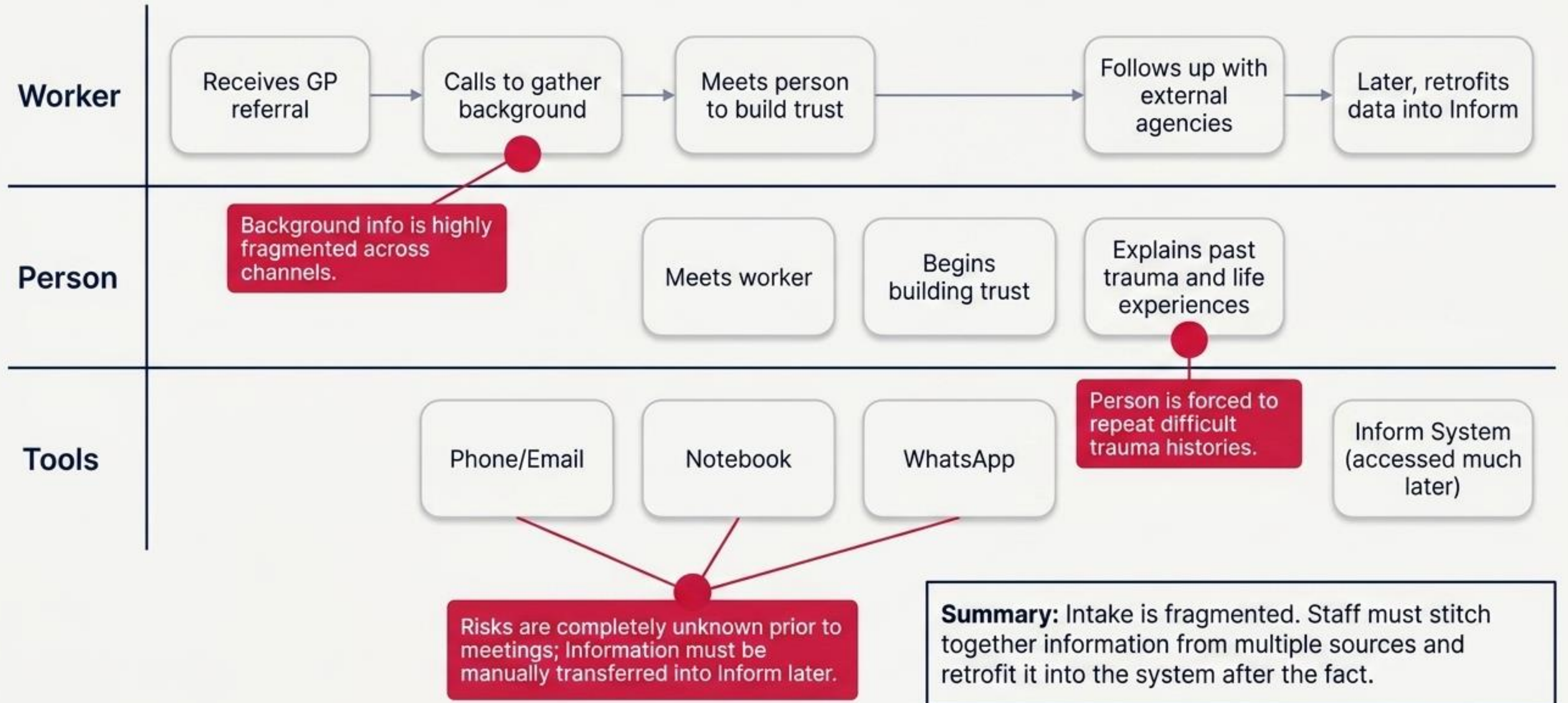
Supported Person Actions

Tools & Systems

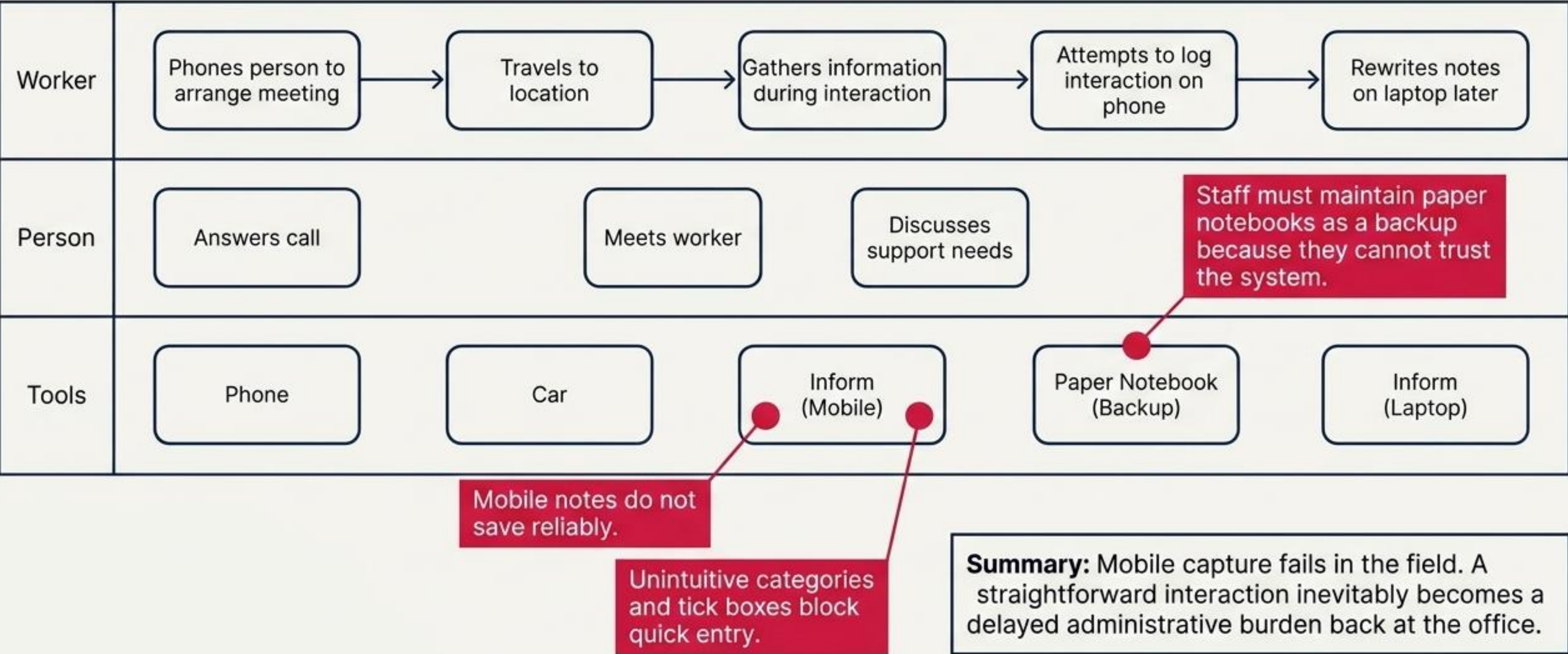


Friction Points

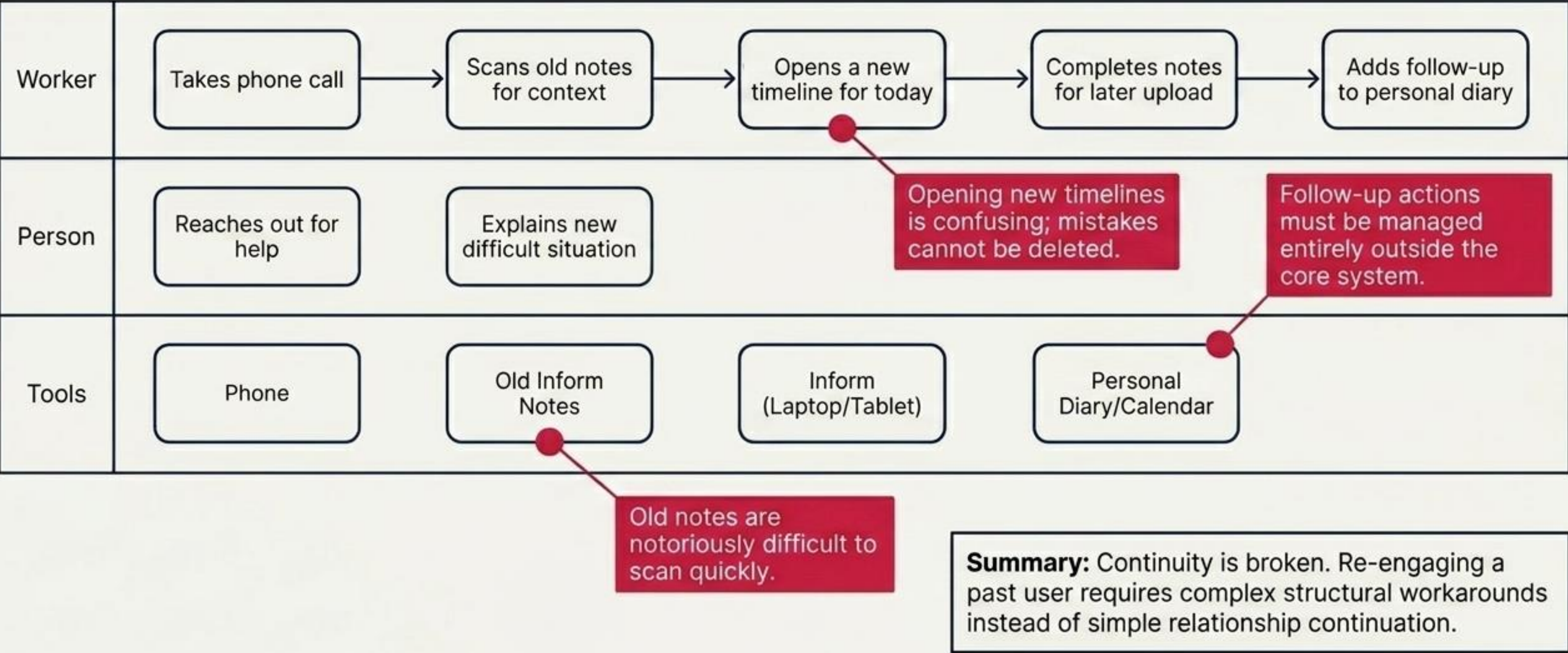
Journey 1: GP Referral (Intake & Setup)



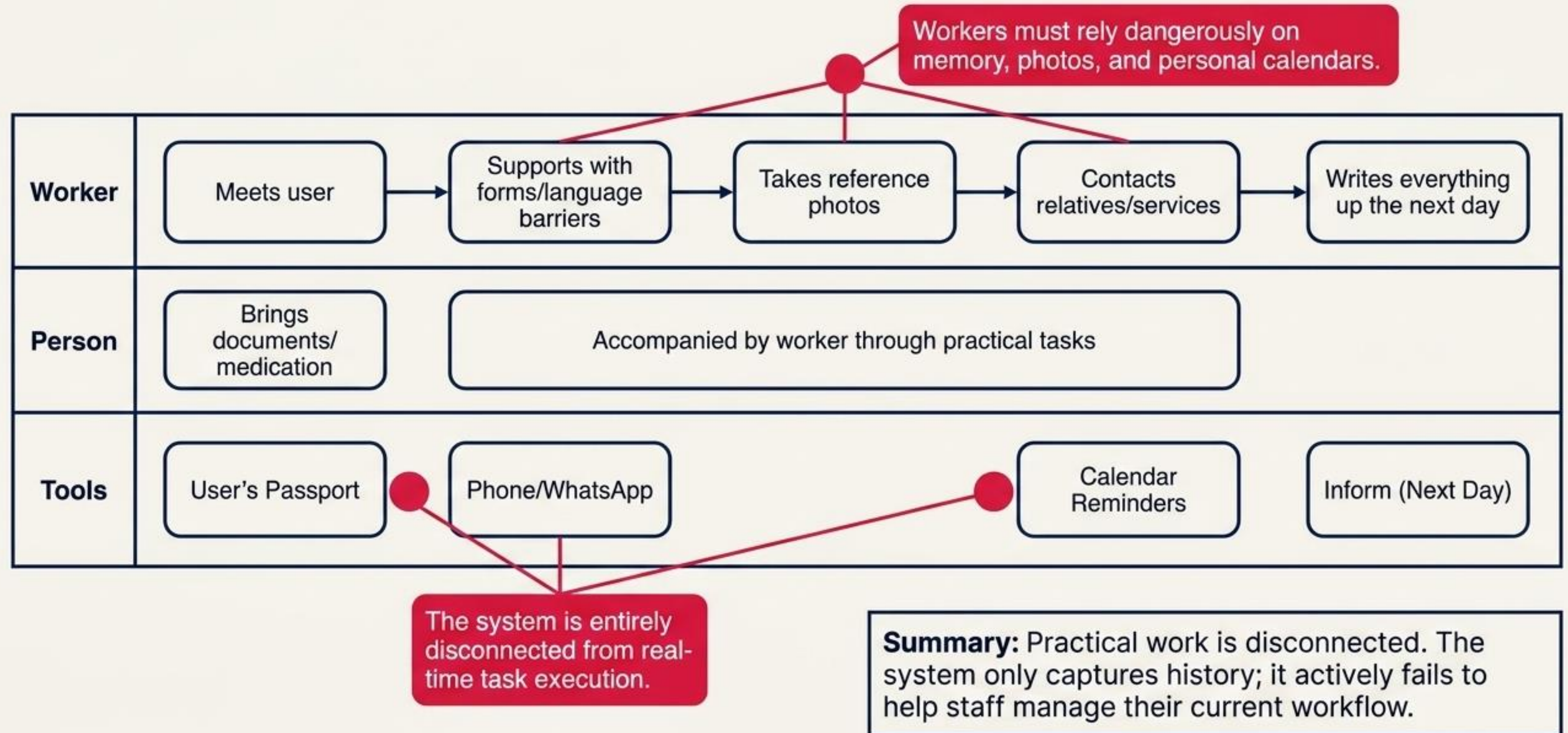
Journey 2: Arranging an Appointment (Mobile Capture)



Journey 3: Returning Service User (Continuity)



Journey 4: Practical Tasks & Follow-up



Voices from the Frontline

“ Click, click, click, click, click, click, click. That’s seven or eight clicks to just put a note on. ”

It’s just labourious to get to that point, isn’t it?

If notes don’t save, I have to wait until I get on the laptop and do them again.

You can’t add, like, a quick note. We just want to put a note on, then do the tick boxes and the time.

Find time in day to update notes – can forget if don’t do fairly soon.

The Systemic Friction (Thematic Synthesis)

In-the-moment capture is unreliable.

Creates dependence on notebooks, WhatsApp, and memory.

Simple tasks take too many steps.

Creating timelines or adding notes involves excessive clicks and fields.

Mismatched mental models.

System structure makes sense to the software, but not to the people doing the work.

Unbalanced reporting needs.

Data capture is necessary, but the friction created by how it is captured is disproportionate.

External task management.

Follow-ups and reminders sit dangerously outside the system.

Insufficient trauma-informed design.

Support plans and risk tools fail to match the complexity of real lives.

The Core Problem

Frontline staff need a case management process that fits the reality of mobile, time-pressured, trauma-informed support work.

Because the current Inform experience makes it too difficult to capture and access information quickly, it creates an unnecessary admin burden that directly reduces time spent with the people they support.

Requirement Translation (Capture & Navigation)

The Sub-Problem	Functional Requirement Signal	How Might We... Design Prompt
"In-the-moment" capture fails.	Reliable mobile-first note capture with save confidence.	How might we help staff capture information quickly and reliably without disrupting the interaction?
Notes take too many steps.	Quick note creation with minimal mandatory fields.	How might we reduce the steps, fields, and decisions to record a simple action?
Confusing record navigation.	Easier access to previous context and simplified timeline creation.	How might we make it easier to find context and continue records without confusion?

Requirement Translation (Data, Tasks & Trauma)

The Sub-Problem	Functional Requirement Signal	How Might We... Design Prompt
Reporting needs lack usability balance.	Configurable categories that better reflect frontline work.	How might we capture needed reporting data while keeping frontline recording proportionate?
Follow-ups managed externally.	Integrated reminders linked to a person's case.	How might we help staff manage reminders and next actions in one trusted place?
Rigid support planning tools.	Improved handling of risk assessments and support plans.	How might we redesign support planning so it is clearer, practical, and trauma-informed?

Design & Technical Mandates

Usability & Workflow

- ✓ Design for interrupted, mobile, low-attention environments.
- ✓ Make current status and next actions visible at a glance.
- ✓ Support quick scanning of recent history before contact.
- ✓ Use trauma-informed language that aligns with frontline understanding.

Non-Functional & Technical Quality

- ✓ Ensure reliable saving with clear visual confirmation.
- ✓ Optimize performance for the actual mobile devices used in the field.
- ✓ Build resilience for variable connectivity.
- ✓ Automate auditability without forcing front-end burden onto users.

The North Star

A case management experience that fits frontline outreach work, enabling staff to record, access and act on information easily in the moment, while improving service quality and freeing up more time for direct support.

Success measures

- less admin burden, faster and easier capture in the moment
 - less duplication and fewer workarounds
 - better continuity, follow-up and risk visibility
 - more time spent with more people

Next Steps: Designing the Future

The opportunity is not simply to redesign screens. It is to redesign the case management experience around the realities of outreach, continuity, and trust.

1

Use the 'How Might We' questions as breakout prompts for mixed groups of developers, designers, and stakeholders.

2

Prioritise concepts that support quick capture and continuity, strictly testing solutions against both straightforward notes and complex interventions.

3

Keep trauma-informed working and staff trust as non-negotiable design criteria, not afterthoughts.